

Saturday, 10 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 15° 11°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 13° 10°	MANCHESTER Heavy drizzle 13° 10°	GLASGOW Heavy drizzle 12° 8°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The man accused of murdering former Conservative minister Ann Widdecombe had a 'particular hostility to Reform UK', a court has heard.

Kerry is charged with the murder of the 78-year-old, who was a spokeswoman for the party. The trial continues to hear evidence regarding the alleged motive.

CRIME · UK
- 2

A man has admitted murdering his former partner after she started a new relationship, following previous knife attacks.

Lee Inglis had twice avoided prison for earlier assaults on Stacey Hogg in Hawick. This tragic case highlights serious concerns about domestic violence and repeat offending.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Prime Minister Andy Burnham has pledged to curb non-compete clauses in job contracts, arguing the restrictions have 'gone too far'.

These clauses limit what workers can do after leaving a role. The government believes this move will boost economic dynamism and worker mobility.

POLITICS · UK
- 4

A father and son remain in critical condition after a masked gang attacked them at their Leicestershire home.

Police describe the incident as 'completely unprovoked' and are appealing for witnesses. The community is understandably shocked by the violent home invasion.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Yorkshire has officially declared a drought after experiencing its fifth driest period on record.

Between April and September, rainfall levels were significantly low. This declaration could lead to water restrictions across the region.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A music group for people with learning difficulties is set to fulfil a late MP's dream by performing on Broadway.**

The Music Man Project, an Essex-based charity, teaches music to those with learning disabilities. This incredible achievement promises to be a truly heartwarming event.

ON AIR – What an uplifting story! What's a dream you've seen come true, either for yourself or someone else?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Wolverhampton-born singer Beverley Knight has described her role as suffragette leader Emmeline Pankhurst in the musical Sylvia as 'a gift'.**

The acclaimed performer is currently starring in the production. It's a powerful story brought to life by a fantastic talent.

ON AIR – Beverley Knight playing Emmeline Pankhurst – what a dream casting! Who would you love to see play a historical figure?

THEATRE · NOW
- 3 Dolly Parton has recorded a Welsh version of her smash-hit song 'Jolene', which is released today.**

The new rendition features both Welsh and English lyrics. It's a delightful surprise from the country music legend!

ON AIR – Dolly Parton singing in Welsh! What's the most unexpected musical collaboration or cover you've ever heard?

MUSIC · NOW
- 4 The hit film 'Crazy Rich Asians' is set to return as a TV show, with the original movie's stars expected to reprise their roles.**

The series will pick up after the events of the 2018 romantic comedy. Fans will be thrilled to see Constance Wu, Henry Golding, and Michelle Yeoh back on screen.

ON AIR – Crazy Rich Asians coming back as a TV show – brilliant news! What film would you love to see get a spin-off series?

TV · COMING UP
- 5 Hollywood actor Luke Evans has spoken about his 'joyous' four months filming in his native Wales, despite the rainy weather.**

His family visited the set, and he even managed to get some relatives cameo roles. It sounds like a lovely homecoming for the star.

ON AIR – Luke Evans getting his family cameos! What's the most unexpected place you've ever spotted a celebrity?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Manchester United boss Michael Carrick says he has 'his own questions' about the Manchester City financial breaches case.**

City were found guilty of breaking Premier League financial rules, a verdict that Carrick admits personally affected him. The fallout from the ruling continues to be a major talking point.

ON AIR – Michael Carrick says he has questions about the Man City verdict. Do you think the punishments are fair, or should they be tougher?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Former NFL Super Bowl winner Jason Kelce has stunned amateur London rugby players by showing up for a practice game.**

The ex-Philadelphia Eagles star tried his hand at rugby, proving his sporting versatility. It must have been quite a surprise for the local club!

ON AIR – Jason Kelce playing amateur rugby in London! What's the most random celebrity encounter you've had at a local sports event?

RUGBY · UK

3 **Manchester City manager Enzo Maresca insists the club's titles are 'absolutely not' tainted, despite being found guilty of financial breaches.**

Maresca's comments come after the Premier League found City guilty of 115 charges. The debate over the legitimacy of their past successes continues.

ON AIR – Maresca says Man City's titles aren't tainted. Do you agree, or do you think the verdict changes how we look at their achievements?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Novak Djokovic has suffered a surprise second-round loss at the Shanghai Masters, just days after his China Open triumph.**

He was beaten by Hubert Hurkacz in a shock result. It shows that even the very best can have an off day on court.

ON AIR – Djokovic crashing out in Shanghai! Does this make the rest of the tennis season more exciting, knowing anyone can be beaten?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

5 **Leeds Rhinos legend Ryan Hall has announced his retirement from rugby league at the age of 38.**

The legendary winger spent 16 years with the Rhinos, becoming one of their most decorated players. He leaves behind an incredible legacy in the sport.

ON AIR – Ryan Hall retiring – a true legend of rugby league. Who's your all-time favourite player from any sport who's hung up their boots?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The delightful art of 'doodling while on the phone' is being celebrated as a genuine boost for memory and focus.**
New findings suggest that those little scribbles we make during conversations aren't just idle distraction; they actually help us retain information and stay more engaged. So, next time you're on a long call, grab a pen and paper!
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'a perfectly made sandwich, cut just right' is experiencing a quiet revival.**
Forget fancy gourmet concoctions; experts are noticing a growing appreciation for the humble sandwich, especially when it's made with care and neatly portioned. It seems presentation really does matter, even for a packed lunch.
- 3 Research shows that 'the gentle clinking of cutlery' during a meal can actually enhance the dining experience.**
It's not just about the food and company; the subtle sounds of forks and knives on plates are found to contribute to a sense of contentment and enjoyment. Perhaps it's a nostalgic connection to family meals.
- 4 There's a growing trend to appreciate 'the unique smell of old books' as a comforting aroma.**
Book lovers are increasingly reporting that the distinctive scent of aged paper and bindings brings a sense of calm and nostalgia. It's being recognised as a pleasant, grounding experience in our busy lives.
- 5 The quiet satisfaction of 'finding a matching pair of socks in the laundry pile' is being highlighted as a small daily win.**
In a world full of challenges, the simple triumph of uniting two stray socks from the washing machine is providing a surprising moment of joy. It's a tiny victory we can all relate to.
- 6 The delightful habit of 'waving to a passing train driver' is being celebrated as a charming, old-fashioned gesture.**
It seems a small wave from a platform or a bridge to those at the controls of a train is still a lovely way to connect. Many drivers apparently enjoy returning the friendly greeting.
- 7 The unexpected joy of 'successfully catching a piece of toast as it pops up' is a quiet thrill for many.**
That split-second reaction to grab your breakfast before it hits the kitchen floor is proving to be a surprisingly satisfying achievement. It's a tiny moment of victorious agility to start the day.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of marmalade, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?

ANSWER: THEY ABSOLUTELY HAVE TO 'TAP THE LID THREE TIMES' BEFORE TWISTING IT OPEN, JUST FOR GOOD LUCK AND TO ENSURE A PERFECT SPREAD!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: THEY SECRETLY 'SNIFF THE PACKAGING INTENSELY' BEFORE BUYING, BELIEVING THE AROMA THROUGH THE PLASTIC WILL TELL THEM EVERYTHING THEY NEED TO KNOW!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you pick up a 'random, unusual item' in a charity shop – maybe an old board game with missing pieces, a peculiar piece of art, or a really specific kitchen gadget – and you just can't resist taking it home?

What's the most unusual thing you've ever bought from a second-hand shop, and did it ever actually get used or find its purpose?

- We all have that 'one particular local landmark or feature' that, perhaps to others, seems a bit ordinary, but to you, it holds a special place in your heart or brings back lovely memories.

What's that understated local spot that means something special to you, and why is it so charming?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that in the 17th century, pineapples were so rare and expensive in England that people would rent them for a day to display at parties?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that the iconic red telephone boxes were originally painted blue, but were changed after public complaints that they blended in too much with the sky?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwllllantysiliogogogoch, a village in Wales.
- Bears are born without hair and are blind for their first month.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The Great Fire of London in 1666 largely helped to eradicate the Black Death in the city.
- The inventor of the Richter scale, Charles F. Richter, was ironically afraid of earthquakes.
- Flamingos get their pink colour from the beta-carotene in their diet of brine shrimp and algae.
- The world's first underground railway, the Metropolitan Railway, opened in London in 1863.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.

On this day

Day 283 of the year, 82 days left in 2026. Today Aleksis Kivi Day, also known as the Finnish Literature Day (Finland); Arbor Day (Poland); Army Day (Sri Lanka); Capital Liberation Day (Vietnam). Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1953 — Midge Ure, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1969 — Wendi McLendon-Covey, American actress
- 1989 — Emer Kenny, English actress and screenwriter
- 1946 — Anne Mather, English author and screenwriter
- 1970 — Matthew Pinsent, English rower and sportscaster
- 1965 — Chris Penn, American actor (died 2006)
- 1981 — Laura Tobin, English weather reporter
- 1961 — Martin Kemp, English singer-songwriter and bass player

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Aeroflot Flight 773 is destroyed by a bomb over Moscow Oblast, killing 25.
- 1963 — France cedes control of the Bizerte naval base to Tunisia.
- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1997 — Austral Líneas Aéreas Flight 2553 crashes and explodes in Uruguay, killing 74.
- 2022 — Ben S. Bernanke, Douglas W. Diamond and Philip H. Dybvig are jointly awarded the Nobel Memorial Prize in Economic Sciences.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2015 — Twin bomb blasts in the Turkish capital Ankara kill 109 and injure 500+.
- 1985 — US Navy aircraft intercept an Egyptian airliner carrying the perpetrators of the Achille Lauro hijacking, and force it to land in Italy.
- 1970 — Fiji becomes independent.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 284 of the year, 81 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Agilbert; Christian feast days: Alexander Sauli; Christian feast days: Andronicus, Probus, and Tarachus (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast days: Æthelburh of Barking. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Dawn French, Welsh-English actress, comedian and screenwriter
- 1976 — Emily Deschanel, American actress and producer
- 1962 — Joan Cusack, American actress
- 1944 — Rodney Marsh, English footballer, manager, and sportscaster
- 1932 — Dottie West, American singer-songwriter and actress (died 1991)
- 1968 — Jane Krakowski, American actress and singer
- 1956 — Stephen Spinella, American actor
- 1971 — Petra Haden, American violinist and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1941 — Beginning of the National Liberation War of Macedonia.
- 1987 — The AIDS Memorial Quilt is first displayed during the Second National March on Washington for Lesbian and Gay Rights.
- 2018 — Soyuz MS-10, launching an intended crew for the ISS, suffers an in-flight abort. The crew lands safely.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1142 — A peace treaty ends the Jin–Song wars.
- 1942 — World War II: Off Guadalcanal, United States Navy ships intercept and defeat a Japanese force.

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar